UNIVERSITY OF GUYANA
FACULTY OF EDUCATION AND HUMANITIES
DEPARTMENT OF RESEARCH AND GRADUATE STUDIES

COURSE CODE AND TITLE: EFN 5106 The Adolescent Learner

No. of Credits - 3
Exemptions – Nil
Pre-Requisite – Nil
Indications of Follow-on Course: EDC 5000 Practicum (Practice in Education)

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course begins with the contribution of psychology to an understanding of adolescent growth and development. It offers an introduction to the teaching/learning process focusing on the needs of adolescents. The course examines the role of the teacher/educator in relation to methods/techniques which will enhance teacher effectiveness and examines student learning. Approaches for dealing with adolescent problems are also addressed and some provision is made for the identification and diagnosis of adolescents with special needs and how helping relationships to cater for same may be established.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- examine the contribution of psychology to an understanding of adolescent growth and development;
- offer an analysis of psychological view points on adolescent growth and development
- examine ways in which the teacher/educator may enhance teaching and maximize learning during this period;
- critically evaluate relevant literature and reflect on some in an attempt to solve classroom problems;
- demonstrate a working understanding of sound psychological principles and practices for dealing with the troubled adolescent;
- recognize and begin the process of remediation of adolescents with special educational needs.

CONTENT

WK. 1 Psychology as a science of behavior

- The role of science in explaining growth, learning and development
- Schools in psychology – psychoanalysis, behaviourism, humanism, cognitive

WK. 2 Introduction to Adolescent Development

- What is adolescence?
- Developmental tasks of adolescence

WK 3 Physical and Sexual Development

- Physical changes
- Primary and Secondary sex characteristics
- Body image
- Early and late matures
- Sexual development

WK. 4 Cognitive Development

- Piaget: Formal operational thought
- Elkind: Adolescent egocentrism
- Kohlberg: Moral Development

WK. 5 Social and Emotional Development

- Family relationships
- Peer relationships
- Adolescents with emotional disturbances

WK. 6 Personality Development (Nature/nature controversy)

- Examination of approaches to personality development (physiological, behavioural, psychoanalytic, trait/type, humanist)

WK. 7 Erikson's Psycho-social Theory

- Identity and self-concept
- The intelligence Quotient

WK. 8 School Experiences

- New developmental tasks
- Student attitudes toward school

- The role of teachers
- Other influence and effects
- The high school drop-out

WK. 9 Vocational Choices

- Some career considerations
- Important sources of influence
- Working during high school

WK. 10 Problems of Adolescence

- Various forms of maladjustments
- Treatment approaches
- Juvenile delinquency
- Drug dependency
- Teenage pregnancy

WK. 11 Adolescents with Special Needs

- Nature of students with special needs
- Diagnosis of such needs
- Attempts at helping in the regular classroom
- The classroom teacher and community based rehabilitation
- Assistance from special agencies

WK. 12 The teacher as a counselor establishing helping relationships

- What is counseling?
- Elements of effective counseling

WK. 13 Developing Self Awareness

- Establishing a helping relationship (responding skills, leading skills)
- Rogerian therapy

WK. 14 Review

WK. 15 Final Examinations

METHOD OF TEACHING

The course will be taught through lecture, discussion, group, and individual presentations.

WEIGHTING OF THE COURSE

Continuous Assessment (Course Work) 100%

ASSIGNMENTS:

Individual Assignments:

1. Long Paper: An investigation into a psychological issue to be given the second week of the semester. Submission date is the end of the 6th week of Semester. 20 marks
2. In-class Test: On the 7th week of Semester. 20 marks
3. Final Test: On the 15th week of Semester. 30 marks
4. **Group Assignment**: Tutorial Presentations: An oral component worth 20 marks and a written component worth 10 marks. 30 marks

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

- Attend classes and tutorials regularly
- Complete assigned readings
- Submit all course assignments
- Take Final TEST at the end of semester

RECOMMENDED READING

Berk, L. E. (2006). *Child development*. (7th ed). N.Y: Pearson Education Inc.

Freiberg, K. L. (2002). *Educating exceptional children*. USA: McGraw Hill/ Dushkin.

Kail, R. (2007). *Children and their development*. New Jersey: Pearson Education Ltd.

Santrock, J. (2009). *Educational psychology*. (4th ed.) N.Y: McGraw Hill.

Santrock, J. (1996). *Adolescence*. U.S.A Brown & Benchmark Publishers

Rice, F. P. & Dolgin, K. G. (2005). *The adolescent development, relationships and culture*. (11th ed.) N.Y: Pearson.

Schmdt, J. J. (1993). *Counselling in schools*. Boston: Allyn & Beacon.

Venkataiah, S. (2001). *Fundamentals of adult education*. Delhi: Amol Publications Pvt. Ltd.